Agriculture Policy

The Green Party will support all parts of the agricultural sector to look after our environment so that it sustains our communities and builds our resilience to multiple impacts, including climate and market instability. This policy shows that everyone in Aotearoa New Zealand can eat good food that is more affordable for our local consumers and gets a fair price for our food and fibre producers. Our sustainable agricultural practices will create products that are in high demand globally. Farmers will be supported to keep innovating and improving, and good data collection will ensure that agencies provide real-time feedback to inform that progress.

Vision

The agricultural sector upholds the mana of the land, people, and animals.

Values and Principles

Agriculture policy must be guided by the following values and principles:

- *Kawanatanga*: Governance of the agricultural sector recognises the unique expertise and rights of Māori. Māori participation in shaping the future of agriculture is equitable.
- *Tiakina te taiao, tiakina te iwi e*: The agricultural sector protects our diverse ecosystems to sustain our communities using a precautionary approach for future generations. Mātauranga Māori guides our agricultural practices and environmental standards.
- *Ka mua, ka muri*: The agricultural sector recognises its impact on climate change and commits to reduced emissions.
- *Te Rāngai aumangea*: The agricultural sector is supported to adapt to a changing environment, including the land and weather patterns.
- *Te Rāngai tōnui*: The agricultural sector is supported to be financially viable. This viability includes ecological health and egalitarian human systems.
- *Tauutuutu*: Agriculture depends on relationships. Where these relationships have been undermined or damaged, they must be repaired.
- *Tiaki kararehe*: Farm animals are sentient beings deserving of our care and protection.

Strategic Priorities

The Green Party's strategic goals include:

Our nation will lead the world in sequestering carbon through ecologically sound means.

> *"...regenerative practices in all areas of economic activity, including land use and food production, will predominate."*

"Aotearoa will be in transition, creating green work and broad prosperity while moving Aotearoa away from carbon-dependent, extractive and resource-intensive industries."

Actions in this policy that will help achieve this include:

- Implement the recommendations of the Waitangi Tribunal to ensure that governance of the agricultural sector upholds Te Tiriti o Waitangi. (1.2)
- Establish an Agricultural Standards Framework that includes… sustainability standards for all food and fibre sectors. (2.1.3)
- Incentivise low greenhouse gas agricultural initiatives. (3.3)
- Strengthen the collective resilience of grassroots community collaborations such as local catchment groups. (4.4)
- Provide startup funding for innovative systems and/or new food and fibre trials. (5.1)
- Resource a Māori-led authority that oversees the distribution of start-up funding to Māori agricultural initiatives that are locally led and sustainable. (6.3)

Connected Policies

Agriculture is an important Business and Food-producing activity that is shaped by the Government in the Economy. It is important for Rural Communities, Animal Welfare, and Trade and Foreign Investment. It is interconnected with and key to safeguarding the natural world, including Climate Change, Land Use and Soils, and Freshwater. A range of risks, including exotic organisms and emerging technologies, are addressed in our Biodiversity and Environmental Regeneration Policy, and Research, Science and Technology Policy. Also related are our policies on Forestry and Marine aquaculture.

Policy Positions

1. **Kawanatanga** | Governance

Our Vision

Māori have full access to their own land, which they have resettled and regenerated. They enjoy economic prosperity and have rangatiratanga over mahinga kai. The agriculture sector and regional councils work in partnership with local iwi and hapū in decisions that affect the land, and their expertise is respected.

Actions

1.1. Fund mana whenua to provide culturally appropriate support and guidance to local groups relevant to agriculture, such as catchment groups.

1.2. Implement the recommendations of the Waitangi Tribunal to ensure that governance of the agricultural sector upholds Te Tiriti o Waitangi.

1.3. Support Māori to address barriers found in banking, tax, company and co-operative laws that prevent te ao Māori principles from being applied to the production of food and fibre and/or Māori land use and development.

2. **Tiakina te taiao, tiakina te iwi e** | Look after our environment so that it sustains our communities

Our Vision

Aotearoa New Zealand is known for its premium-quality and environmentally sustainable products. Our native flora and fauna are thriving, and land, soil, and water ecosystems are healthy and valued. Our food and fibre supports the health of both people and the environment.

Actions

2.1. Establish an Agricultural Standards Framework that includes:
  2.1.1. Requirements to measure all agricultural inputs and outputs;
  2.1.2. Robust and consistent measures of environmental impacts caused by agriculture;
  2.1.3. Sustainability standards for all food and fibre sectors; and
  2.1.4. Incentives and other support to farmers to continuously improve ecosystems on productive land.

2.2. Prohibit palm kernel expeller (PKE) imports.

2.3. Impose nitrogen caps on all agricultural practices and prohibit the production of nitrogenous fertilisers from fossil fuels

2.4. Phase out most grazing concessions on public conservation land and require sustainable farm plans for active concessions.

2.5. Support farmers in sensitive ecosystems to work collaboratively to protect indigenous biodiversity.

3. **Ka mua, ka muri** | Look to our past practices, to inform the future

Our Vision

The agricultural sector has achieved a significant cut in gross emissions. The sector works together as a whole to maintain this. All agricultural businesses are proud of their positive contribution to clean air and a safe climate.

Actions

3.1. Require the agriculture sector to provide data that enables greenhouse gas emissions to be measured.

3.2. Reduce agricultural emissions in Aotearoa New Zealand by:
  3.2.1. Adjusting stocking rates according to the holding capacity of the land;
  3.2.2. Protecting existing wetlands and encouraging wetland restoration;
  3.2.3. Phasing out the use of fossil fuels for agricultural processes; and
  3.2.4. Phasing out synthetic nitrogen fertilisers.

3.3. Incentivise low greenhouse gas agricultural initiatives.

4. Te rāngai aumangea | A resilient sector

Our Vision

The agricultural sector is resilient, diversified, and agile in the face of changing weather patterns, markets, and consumer demands. The sector maintains its focus on sustainable and ethical agriculture, and in the development and processing of crops and technologies to support that focus.

Actions

4.1. Require imported foods to meet our own national growing and production requirements.

4.2. Support a transition to agroecological practices (such as regenerative and organic approaches).

4.3. Encourage the preservation and growing of heritage seeds for personal use as well as commercial production.

4.4. Strengthen the collective resilience of grassroots community collaborations such as local catchment groups.

5. Te rāngai tōnui | A thriving sector

Our Vision

Agriculture is collaborative and farmers produce high quality products for good prices. Community Supported Agriculture and farmers' markets are thriving. Communities benefit from local and seasonal food production that is nutritious, safe, fresh, and affordable. Our sustainable agricultural practices create products that are in high demand globally. Agriculture is an accessible and desirable career path for youth.

Actions

5.1. Provide startup funding for innovative systems and/or new food and fibre trials.

5.2. Fund ongoing research to explore sustainable agricultural livelihoods that require fewer energy, time, and cost inputs.

5.3. Resource innovative projects that address the food and fibre needs of local communities.

6. Tauutuutu | Reciprocity and honouring traditional practices

Our Vision

Mātauranga Māori is well recognised, and tangata whenua are supported to grow, forage, hunt for, and exchange their products of the land. The mana of the people, their healthy food, and their land are sustained through adapting traditional practices to a modern world.

Actions

6.1. Prioritise iwi-based initiatives in the management and restoration of retired and/or degraded agricultural land.

6.2. Fund research and development that supports hapū and iwi Māori agribusiness.

6.3. Resource a Māori-led authority that oversees the distribution of start-up funding to Māori agricultural initiatives that are locally led and sustainable.

6.4. Protect and enhance the cultural, spiritual, historical, and other values of agricultural land.

7. Tiaki kararehe | Caring for animals

Our Vision

The agricultural sector consistently uses an ethical and humane approach to managing animals. Our approach is world-leading, and animals enjoy the highest animal welfare standards, with their death managed as humanely as possible. Welfare standards are properly enforced and the need for prosecution is rare.

Actions

7.1. Ban the importation of animals and animal products when living conditions in their country of origin have not met Aotearoa New Zealand's animal welfare standards.

7.2. Resource animal welfare inspectors and prosecutors to fully uphold the Animal Welfare Act.

7.3. Address the requirements of the Global Animal Protection Index to improve animal welfare.

7.4. Prohibit new, and phase out existing factory farming of animals, including highly intensive outdoor facilities such as feedlots.

7.5. Adopt fit-for-purpose animal-centric transport standards, specific to species and age.